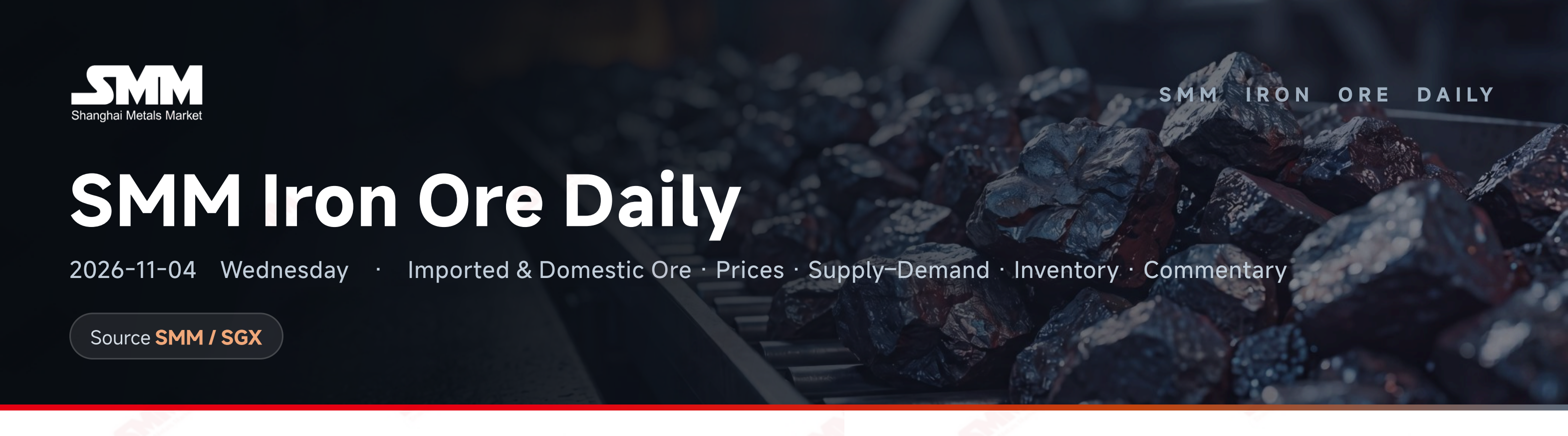


SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-11-04 Wednesday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

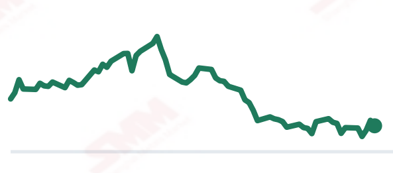
SGX Iron Ore Near-month Contract (2026-11) Latest price

92.00

USD/dmt

FEFX26 · 2026-11 · SGX

As of preparation: 2026-11-04 17:39:20 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 11-04 17:25:06 (UTC+8)



Last 3 months

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

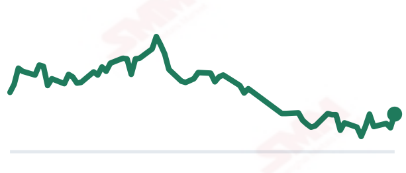
682.0

yuan/mt

▲ +11.0 +1.64%

MTD avg **675.8**

As of Nov 4 · vs Nov 3



Last 3 months

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Nov 4

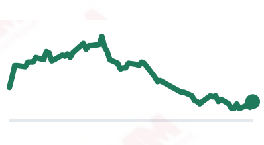
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily

656

yuan/wmt

▲ +5 +0.77%

MTD avg **653**



Last 3 months

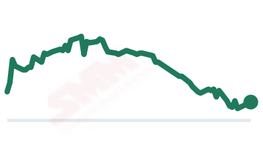
MMi 58% Port Spot Daily

607

yuan/wmt

▲ +2 +0.33%

MTD avg **606**



Last 3 months

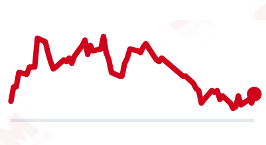
MMi 65% Port Spot Daily

818

yuan/wmt

▲ +5 +0.62%

MTD avg **815**



Last 3 months

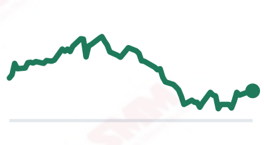
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily

91.10

USD/dmt

▲ +0.40 +0.44%

MTD avg **90.90**



Last 3 months

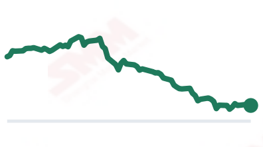
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily

106.75

USD/dmt

▲ +0.35 +0.33%

MTD avg **106.68**



Last 3 months

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily

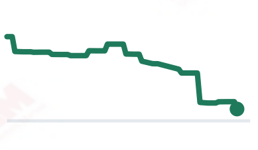
791.29

yuan/mt

▼ -6.15 -0.77%

MTD avg —

As of Oct 30 · vs Oct 29



Last 3 months

Key View

Prices recover as hot metal eases; sustained transactions will determine the rebound's footing

Futures, port and seaborne prices recovered together today while production eased. DCE most-traded closed at 682.0 yuan/mt, up 1.64%, and the 61%, 58% and 65% port indices rose to 656, 607 and 818 yuan/wmt. The seaborne indices reached USD 91.10/dmt for the 61% and 106.75 for the 65%, with all 12 brands higher. Price direction was aligned, suggesting better short-term support, but one rebound does not establish a stronger demand trend.

Surveyed daily hot metal output was 2.3573 million mt on Nov 4, down 4,800 mt, and the blast furnace operating rate fell to 87.06%. Softer baseline consumption alongside firmer prices highlights the different timing of production, procurement and pricing. Lower latest arrivals, reduced ten-port stocks and softer freight offer some cushion, with their subsequent effects still dependent on collections and transactions.

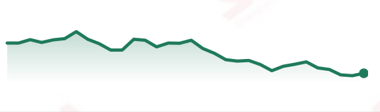
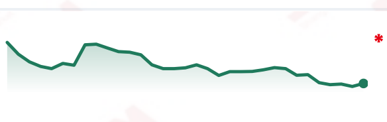
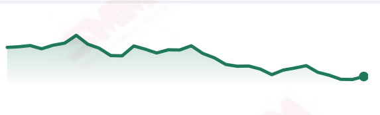
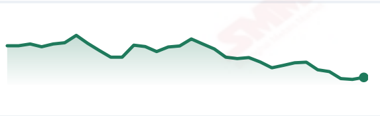
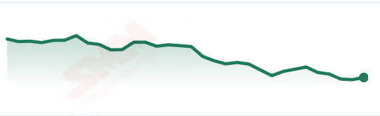
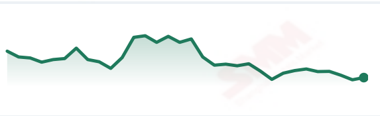
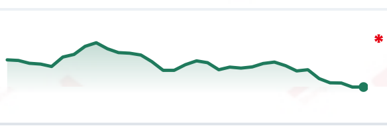
The near-term focus is whether the rebound attracts persistent restocking. Better orders and margins could strengthen downside support; needs-based buying could leave lower production and subsequent supply constraining upside. A cautious, range-bound view remains appropriate, assessing transactions, hot metal and inventories together rather than treating a futures gain alone as a trend reversal.

Today's Highlights

- **Futures and port spot prices recovered.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **682.0 yuan/mt**, up 11.0 yuan (+1.64%) from Nov 3. Qingdao PB and Newman Fines were both 650 yuan/wmt and Mac Fines were 658, each up 10 yuan; PB Lump rose 5 yuan to 815.
- **All five MMi indices and seaborne brands rose.** The 61% seaborne index was **USD 91.10/dmt**, up 0.40 (+0.44%), and the 65% was **106.75**, up 0.35 (+0.33%). All 12 brands increased against the Nov 3 report; PB Fines were 91.40, Newman Fines 90.55 and Mac Fines 90.20 USD/dmt.
- **The port high-low grade spread widened.** The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 656, 607 and 818 yuan/wmt, up 5, 2 and 5 yuan. The 65%-58% spread widened from 208 to 211 yuan/wmt, while the seaborne 65%-61% spread narrowed from USD 15.70 to 15.65/dmt.
- **Hot metal declined WoW, leaving the price recovery dependent on demand support.** Surveyed daily output was **2.3573 million mt** on Nov 4, down 4,800 mt (-0.20%) from Oct 28; the blast furnace operating rate fell 0.24 percentage point to 87.06%. Prices and production did not move together, keeping purchasing persistence in focus.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	11-04 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	650	▲ +10 +1.56%	645	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	650	▲ +10 +1.56%	645	 *
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	658	▲ +10 +1.54%	652	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	698	▲ +10 +1.45%	693	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	820	▲ +10 +1.23%	817	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	512	▲ +10 +1.99%	507	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	822	▲ +10 +1.23%	817	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	815	▲ +5 +0.62%	813	 *

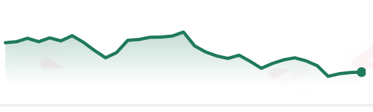
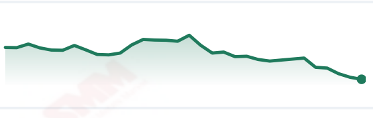
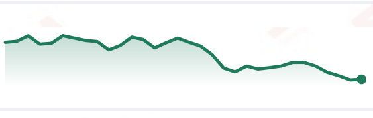
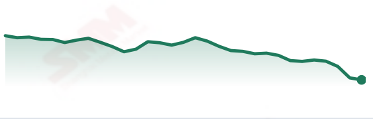
Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	11-04 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	11-03
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	87.55	▲ +0.40 +0.46%	87.15
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	88.40	▲ +0.40 +0.45%	88.00
PB Fines 62% Daily	91.40	▲ +0.40 +0.44%	91.00
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	90.55	▲ +0.40 +0.44%	90.15
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	90.20	▲ +0.35 +0.39%	89.85
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	87.35	▲ +0.40 +0.46%	86.95
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	107.10	▲ +0.40 +0.37%	106.70
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	98.00	▲ +0.40 +0.41%	97.60
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	97.70	▲ +0.40 +0.41%	97.30
RTX Fines 61% Daily	87.55	▲ +0.40 +0.46%	87.15
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	89.90	▲ +0.35 +0.39%	89.55
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	79.75	▲ +0.40 +0.50%	79.35

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.90	+0.73%	-14.0%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	106.68	-1.53%	-12.0%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	653	-0.53%	-19.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	815	-0.30%	-9.0%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	606	-1.40%	-15.5%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	—	—	-10.7%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 91.10/dmt (+0.44%) and the 65% was 106.75 (+0.33%), narrowing their spread from USD 15.70 to 15.65/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 656, 607 and 818 yuan/wmt, up 5, 2 and 5 yuan.

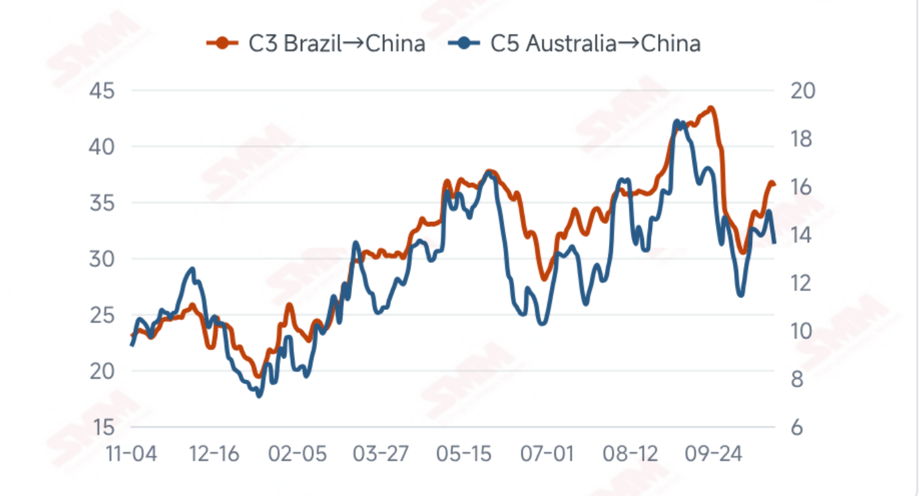
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

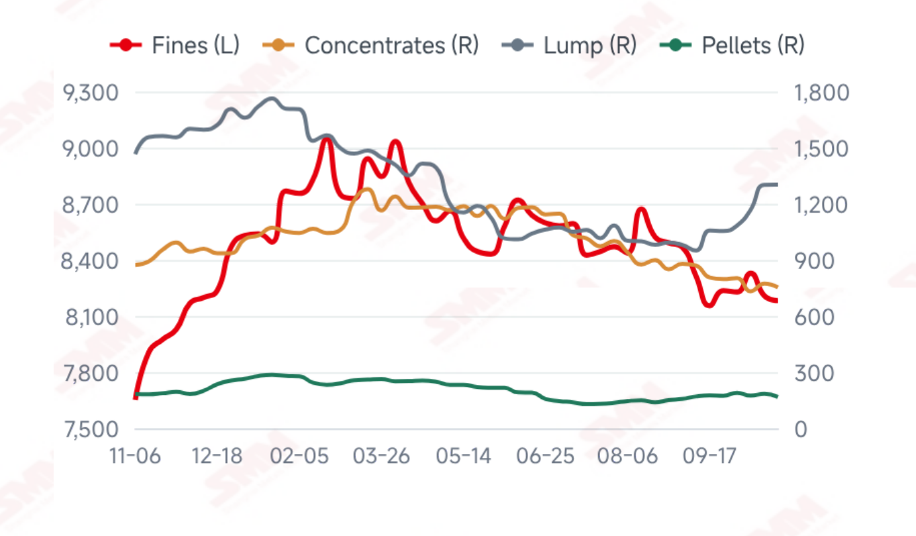
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



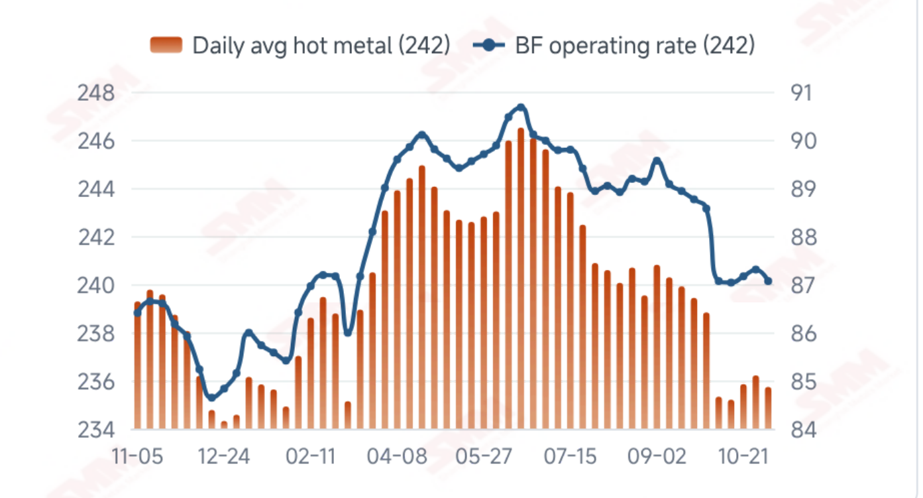
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



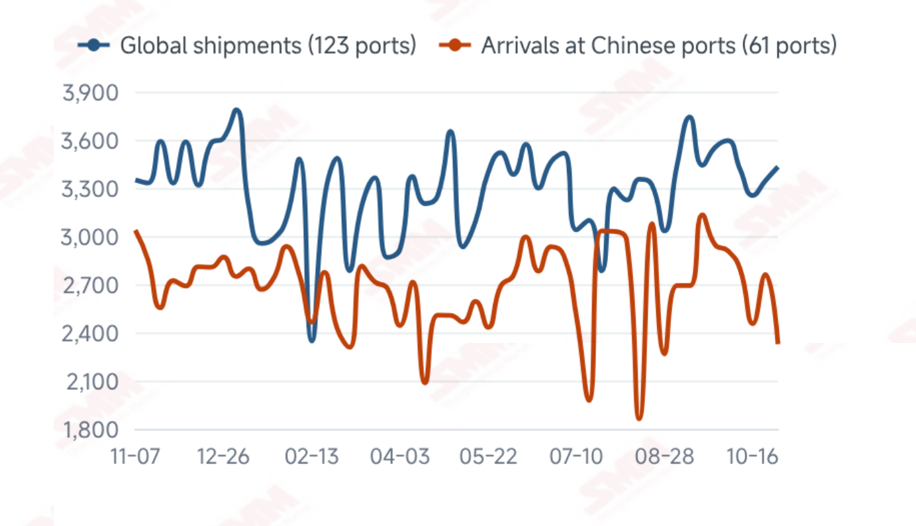
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 682.0 yuan/mt, up 1.64% from the previous session. Qingdao PB Fines were 650, Newman Fines 650, Mac Fines 658, BRBF 698, Newman Lump 820, SSF 512 and Carajas Fines 822 yuan/wmt, each up 10 yuan; PB Lump rose 5 yuan to 815. SGX official near-month FEFX26 (November 2026) was last priced at USD 92.00/dmt, timestamped Nov 4, 17:25:06 (UTC+8). SMM's daily review described normal trader selling, limited mill buying appetite and moderate spot transactions.
Drivers	Futures, port and seaborne quotations recovered together, with relatively aligned short-term price performance. The port high-low spread widened while the seaborne grade spread narrowed slightly, reflecting different resource baskets and purchasing schedules. Firmer prices may encourage offers, but a durable recovery still requires orders, mill margins and physical transactions rather than one broad advance establishing stronger aggregate demand.
Demand	SMM's 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3573 million mt on Nov 4, down 4,800 mt from 2.3621 million mt on Oct 28. The blast furnace operating rate fell from 87.30% to 87.06%. Output eased after two modest increases, keeping marginal changes in baseline consumption in focus. Restocking depends on mill stocks, profitability and end-user orders; production and prices should not be linked through an unverified one-way causal claim.
Inventory & supply	Global shipments were 34.3119 million mt in the week to Oct 30, up 2.58% WoW, while arrivals in China fell 15.73% to 23.2663 million mt. Latest ten-port stocks were 104.0353 million mt on Oct 29, down 618,100 mt from Oct 22. Lower arrivals may ease near-term inflows, but subsequent inventories also depend on unloading, mill collections and the transmission of shipments rather than a single flow defining the balance.
Cost & margin	Nov 3 freight was USD 36.38/mt for C3, down 0.93% from the previous reading, and 13.57 for C5, down 5.63%. Lower freight may ease transport costs for some cargoes, while higher port prices support receipts. Actual margins still depend on procurement contracts, exchange rates and settlement timing; import trading and steelmaking profitability should be assessed separately. SMM's assessment published on the morning of Nov 4 put the period's average import margin at -3.09 yuan/mt, compared with +2.19 previously. This import trading measure is not a post-close margin for the current session and is distinct from steelmaking and coking profitability. Further coke price cuts remain an expectation, not realised cost relief.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	The latest Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 791.29 yuan/mt on Oct 30. SMM's Nov 3 Tangshan brief quoted 66% concentrate at 890–895 yuan/mt on a dry-basis, tax-inclusive delivered-to-mill basis, distinct from the national index in region, grade and delivery terms.
Supply & demand	Previously suspended operations showed no clear restart progress, keeping Tangshan concentrate resources tight. Mill losses and pressure on bids sustained bargaining between buyers and sellers. The latest decline in surveyed hot metal constrains baseline consumption, but regional demand also depends on orders, contracts and collections.
Outlook	SMM's earlier Tangshan brief expected range-bound prices in the short term. Persistent resource constraints alongside recovering purchases could support some offers, while weak profitability and orders could limit upside.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

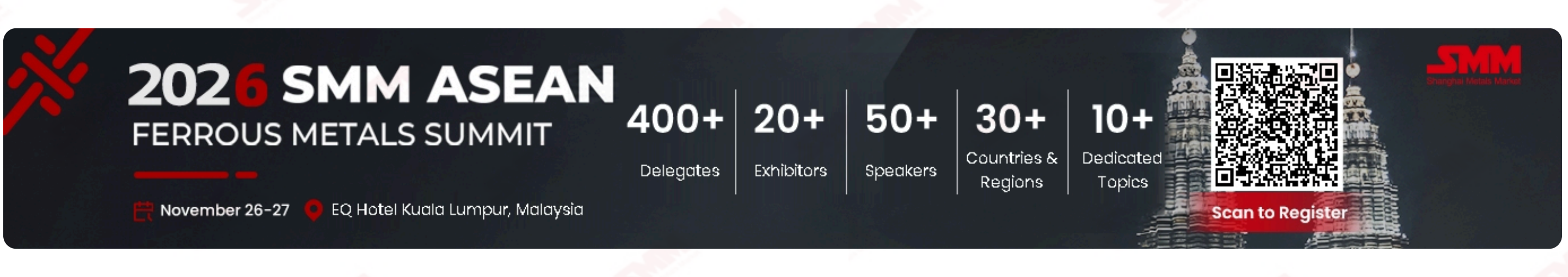
- DCE, all five MMi indices and all 12 seaborne brands recovered together.
- Most port products gained 10 yuan/wmt.
- Latest arrivals in China fell 15.73% and ten-port stocks edged lower.
- Lower C3 and C5 freight cushioned costs for some cargoes.

▼ Bearish factors

- Surveyed daily hot metal output fell 4,800 mt WoW.
- Mill buying remains constrained by margins, orders and raw-material stocks.
- Latest global shipments increased, keeping subsequent arrivals in focus.
- A broad one-day price rise is insufficient to confirm a demand trend reversal.

Flash News

- [SMM Iron Ore] Coke price cut expectations ease bearish pressure on iron ore ↗
  2026-11-04
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Briefing] 20261104 ↗
  2026-11-04
- [SMM Steel] India Steel Prices Largely Flat Ahead of Diwali ↗
  2026-11-04
- [SMM Steel] Turkish Billet: Domestic Prices Bounce on Rebar Restocking, Low-Priced Imports Squeeze Premium ↗
  2026-11-04
- [SMM Steel] Indian HRC Domestic Prices Edge Higher While Export Trading Remains Subdued ↗
  2026-11-04
- [SSAB Americas Q3 2026 shipments fall QoQ to 446,000 mt on planned maintenance outage] ↗
  2026-11-04



Contact Us - (Email :prices@mmiprices.com)

Shu Qing
Domestic Information Sales
+86 187 8199 7577

Wang Jiahui
Domestic Information Sales
+86 155 2492 4450

Leah Zhang
Overseas Information Sales
+86 136 6193 3462

Jack Teah
Overseas Analyst
+60 11 6680 1225

Disclaimer: This report is compiled by SMM from the SMM Data-pro database and SMM's own news coverage. All prices, inventories, output, shipment and arrival figures follow SMM's survey and statistical methodology and are provided for reference only; they do not constitute investment advice. Markets carry risk — please make decisions prudently. Reproduction, excerpting or other use of this report without permission is prohibited.
© 2026 Shanghai Metals Market (SMM)